



Healthier You. Healthier Communities.

DIABETES SELF MANAGEMENT AND EDUCATION SUPPORT PROGRAM Outreach Documents

Luboom Taa(MD, MPH(c) at GWU)

Chronic Care Intern 3/25/26

Unity Health care

Unity Health Care – Anacostia Health Center - Letter
“Unifying to Drop it Low: Learning to Manage Diabetes Confidently”
A Diabetes Self-Management Education and Support (DSMES) Program

Dear Patient,

Managing diabetes can be a challenge, and honestly, most of us need a little extra support to stay on track. Your provider has referred you to our specialized program, **“Unifying to Drop it Low: Learning to Manage Diabetes Confidently,”** to give you the tools and community you need to thrive.

What to Expect

Over the next 8 weeks, you will join a small, supportive group led by Dr. Paola Acevedo (PharmD), a Clinical Pharmacist and Certified Diabetes Care and Education Specialist. Together, you'll tackle the big questions:

- **How to make food choices that support your health without giving up what you love.**
- **The best ways to start an exercise routine and manage your medications.**
- **Practical tips for monitoring blood sugar and reducing the risk of complications.**
- **Ways to build a support network and cope with the daily stress of the diagnosis.**

Your Graduation

After completing the group sessions, you'll receive a **Certificate of Completion** and an optional private, **one-hour 1-on-1 session** with Dr. Acevedo (in-person or virtually) to focus on your specific goals.

Program Details & Location

Your doctor has already reserved your spot! Please mark your calendar for the following sessions:

- ❖ **When: Wednesdays, 10 AM – 12 PM.**
- ❖ **Dates:** Month of April: **1, 8, 15, 22 and 29**; Month of March: **6, 13 and 20.**
- ❖ **Where:** Anacostia Health Center, 1500 Galen St SE #48, Washington, DC 20020)
- ❖ **Important:** Please arrive 10 - 15 minutes early so we can check your blood pressure, glucose level, and weight before we begin.

Note: You will receive a call from the DSMES team for initial assessment before the first day of the program.

We look forward to helping you take control of your health!

Warmly,

The DSMES Team

Unity Health Care – Brentwood Health Center - Letter
“Unifying to Drop it Low: Learning to Manage Diabetes Confidently”
A Diabetes Self-Management Education and Support (DSMES) Program

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- ❖ **Where:** Brentwood Health Center, 1251-B Saratoga Ave NE, 2nd Floor Conference Room.
- ❖ **Important:** Please arrive 10 - 15 minutes early so we can check your blood pressure, glucose level, and weight before we begin.

Note: You will receive a call from the DSMES team for initial assessment before the first day of the program.

We look forward to helping you take control of your health!

Warmly,

The DSMES Team

Unity Health Care – Brentwood Health Center
"Unifying to Drop it Low: Learning to Manage Diabetes
Responsibly"
A Diabetes Self-Management Education and Support
(DSMES) Program



Program

Hi [Patient Name], this is [Your Name] calling from **Unity Health Care**. I'm following up because you recently expressed interest in our diabetes self-management program, '**Unifying to Drop it Low**'. We are currently building our group for **April 2026** and wanted to see if you'd like to claim your spot!"

***** PAUSE *****

If NO: Forward options for July 1 and October 1; also mention virtual option is on the way

If Yes: Wonderful!... we have 2 sites Brentwood (Wed 10AM-12PM) and Anacostia(Wed 1-3pm); which one would you be interested in?

***** PAUSE***** and Confirm Choice

Would you like me to tell you a little bit about Program?

The goal of this 8-week program is to help you find the strategies that work specifically for your life. You'll be working in a small group setting up with our Clinical Pharmacist and Certified Diabetes Educator, Dr. Paola Acevedo.

Some of the things you'll master include:

- ❖ Making food choices that support your health and blood sugar.
- ❖ Understanding your medications and how to monitor your glucose levels
- ❖ Learning ways to start an exercise routine and reduce the risk of future complications.
- ❖ Connecting with others to build a support network

At the end, you'll 'graduate' with a Certificate of Completion and have the option of a private 1-on-1 session with Dr. Acevedo to focus entirely on your personal goals.

Are some of the things I am saying clear?

***** PAUSE*****

Wonderful! Here are some next steps.. You will be receiving a Welcome letter confirming your enrollment and program schedule

You will also be receiving a Phone call from our team for initial assessment before you start our program. The program will start on *Insert Date and Time*, * Insert Location(Text Location)* Please arrive 10 - 15 minutes before the start of the program to have your blood pressure, sugar, and weight checked.

Do you have any questions or concerns at this time? --- Respond accordingly. We look forward to working with you and helping you improve your diabetes control! Thank you!

Optional (If they specifically ask for it) When: Wednesdays from 10 AM – 12 PM or 1-3PM)

- The sessions are held weekly for 8 weeks in a row. These are the dates for April:
- April 1st
- April 8th
- April 15th
- April 22nd
- April 29th
- May 6th
- May 13th
- May 20th

Locations: Brentwood Health Center, 1251-B Saratoga Ave NE, Washington, DC 20018, 2nd floor (Conference Room)
Anacostia Health Center: 1500 Galen St SE #48, Washington, DC 20020